

Karim Valiev

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🇬🇧 UK Global Talent visa holder, based in 🇧🇪 Tbilisi, Georgia

Summary

Cybersecurity leader and hands-on engineer with deep expertise in Python, Linux, networking, databases, and LLM agent systems. Built security teams and infrastructure at scale, as well as an autonomous AI pentesting platform. Experienced in hiring and mentoring engineers while staying deeply involved in architecture and code.

Core Skills

- **Dev:** Python, Go, C/C++, LLM agent systems (LangGraph), Linux kernel & eBPF, Docker/K8s, KVM/QEMU, CI/CD (Ansible, GitHub Actions), MySQL, Elasticsearch, AWS & GCP
 - **Networking:** TCP/IP (L2–L4), Firewalls, datacenter & office networks, VLANs, Scapy
 - **Security:** Pentesting & Bug Bounty, Incident Response / SOC, Vulnerability Management & Code Audits, PKI & Cryptography
 - **Mobile / IoT:** Android internals (NDK, Magisk, Frida), OpenWrt porting (previously unsupported router), ESP8266/ESP32, Bluetooth & Zigbee, Home Assistant & ESPHome
 - **AI-augmented:** Binary reverse engineering, Linux kernel debugging, frontend development (React, TypeScript, JavaScript)
 - **Leadership:** 7 yrs tech management — hiring, mentoring, project & security program delivery
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Experience

Co-founder & Developer, Autonomous AI Pentesting Platform (2025–present)

- Built an end-to-end platform turning company scope into verified, client-ready pentest reports
- Combined deterministic scanning, parallel AI agents, evidence verification, and reporting; evaluated on XBOW, Vulhub, and custom benchmarks
- Built an automated development pipeline: specs → Linear → Codex/Claude → tests → GitHub PRs
- Delivered pilots that uncovered critical vulnerabilities and closed three client sales with my co-founder

Founder & Developer, Attack Surface Management Tool (2022–2025)

- Entire system built myself, except React dashboard: Python scheduler + custom & OSS modules, mapping 100k+ hosts in real time
- Tuned scanning pipeline to sustain 99% CPU / 90% RAM under load, with congestion and packet-loss controls; results indexed in MySQL and Elasticsearch
- One-click deploy (Ansible, Docker, GitHub Actions) on cloud + bare-metal; React dashboard and Telegram alerts; full test/profiling suite

CISO, VK / Mail.Ru (2017–2021)

- Built company-wide security program for 100+ products; scaled team 7 → 50, established per-product security units, and launched a 24×7 SOC + IR center
- Hardened infrastructure: per-service firewalls, YubiKey-based SSH/VPN, certificate Wi-Fi, automated vuln scanning; built and ran a top-7 global HackerOne bug-bounty and recurring 3rd-party red-team exercises
- Led incident response for major breaches, drove M&A security, and served as public security ambassador (conferences, crisis comms, CTF team)

Security Team Lead, VK / Mail.Ru (2014–2017)

Security Analyst, VK / Mail.Ru (2013–2014)

Software Developer, Stream.Ru (2012–2013)

Community & Recognition

- **Open-source:**

<https://github.com/valievkarim/spinrun> - tool to boot a clean, disposable Alpine Linux VM using QEMU in < 0.7s

Bugfixes to public projects: Ansible community.general (2025, included in Ansible), Nuclei scanner (2023), SQLAlchemy (2022), html5lib (2013), MediaInfo (2013)

- **Vulnerability research:**

Featured in Halls of Fame from [Google](#), [Yandex](#), [Mozilla](#), Microsoft, [Alibaba](#) and [Salesforce](#) (2015–2021)

- **CTF:**

Founded VK team – ranked #7 in Russia (2020–2021)

Former core player, MSU “Bushwhackers” – multiple #1 RU/international wins (2010–2015)

- **Public speaking:**

- Launch is Tomorrow podcast – [modern auth](#) (2024), [security at scale](#) (2019)
 - Standoff conf – panel on [cybersecurity careers](#) (2021)
 - Previous talks – [applied crypto](#) (2017), [social media monitoring](#) (2014), [scanner benchmarking](#) (2012)
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Education

M.Sc. Mathematics & Computer Science, Moscow State University (2008–2013)